

Coordinates

To put a sprite in a particular spot, or to find out its exact location, you can use coordinates. Coordinates are a pair of numbers that pinpoint a sprite's position on the stage using an x and y grid.

SEE ALSO

◀ **38–39** Making things move

◀ **52–53** Math

x and y positions

The x and y positions of a sprite and the mouse-pointer are shown on the Scratch interface. It can be helpful to know a sprite's coordinates when writing a script.

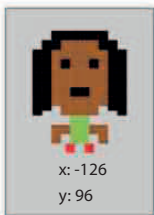
x: 240 y: 180

△ Position of the mouse-pointer

The mouse-pointer's coordinates are shown at the bottom right of the stage. Move the mouse-pointer over the stage and watch the coordinates change.

◁ Position of a sprite

You can see a sprite's current coordinates in the top right corner of the scripts area.



x position



y position

◁ Show coordinates on the stage

Check the boxes beside the "x position" and "y position" blocks to show a sprite's position on the stage.

x and y grid

To pinpoint a spot, count the number of steps left or right, and up or down, from the middle of the stage. Steps to the left or right are called "x". Steps up or down are called "y". Use negative numbers to move left and down.

The stage is based upon an x and y grid

This sprite is 190 steps left (–190) and 150 steps down (–150) from the middle of the stage

